16. Write your own Story

Form groups of five.

Look at the chart given on pages 40-41.

Each person in the group is given only one column to choose from.

From column A, one person chooses any five characters.

From column B, another person can choose any five characteristics or qualities for these characters.

From columns C, D and E, the three remaining children choose the story type, the period and one setting (place) respectively.

The condition is that every person chooses separately, without telling/consulting the others.

After everyone has chosen, you put all the elements together and build a story/play with it.

It must have a beginning, some events and an end.

You may choose other supporting characters and move from one setting or time period to another, if necessary, but you must use what you choose first.

For the teacher : Discuss the activity in the classroom and demonstrate how to choose from the columns. Build one story through a discussion in the classroom. After that, allow children time to build their stories/plays in the classroom itself. Later on, they may write the stories individually or as a group activity. Encourage them to illustrate their story/play.

A : Characters		B : Characteristics	
magician	dog	brave	talkative
school girl	scientist	coward	silly
school boy	a super-hero	wicked	sly
mouse	robot	kind	honest
thief	detective	weak	cunning
soldier	neighbour	bullying	loyal
farmer	elf	nosey	rash
dinosaur	acrobat	forgetful	helpful
merchant	pilot	very intelligent	selfish
king/queen	hawker	scholar	strong

Do you have these elements in your story ?

Good descriptions. (You will need adjectives.)

Events and actions.

C : Story Type	D : Time	E : Places
fairy-tale	In the time of the caveman	Your city/ town/village
fantasy	Once upon a time	On another planet
mystery	One thousand to five hundred years ago	In a faraway land
adventure	Twenty years ago	In a desert
ordinary	Now	In the forest
success story	Twenty years from now	In a hill fort
funny	Two hundred years from now	On an island
science fiction	When dinosaurs lived on the earth	In a big city
tragic		In space
play		In a small kingdom

Dialogues and conversations and also 'monologues', if you like.

Some surprise for the readers!

Please share your story with other groups.